



MONEY VS. LOW HIT RATE · SCRIPT B

Stop funding mass scanning that rarely pays off

About 2.2 min at ~140 words/min · 302 words · Replace [Your Name]. Speak calmly. One speaker, one focus.

Tip: swap bracketed fields. Cite numbers carefully. End with the cancel / yearly-vote ask.

Mayor Crawford, members of City Council. My name is [Your Name], and I live in Crossville.

Please look past the sales pitch and ask what Crossville actually buys.

Automated plate readers scan ordinary drivers constantly. Independent analyses keep showing the same pattern: huge numbers of innocent scans, only a tiny fraction that match a wanted or stolen-vehicle list, and even fewer that become solved crimes. California Highway Patrol documents cited about 0.3 percent alerts per reads. Spokane, WA, and Atlanta, GA, reporting has likewise undercut claims that more cameras automatically mean more crimes get solved.

Crossville has not published local hit rates. It has not published how many cases these cameras actually helped close. It has not published monthly search reports. We are told the system helps. We are not shown the numbers.

Meanwhile Crossville residents pay for cameras that track where we go. If the results were strong, publishing monthly totals would be easy. The silence suggests they are not.

I am not anti-police. I oppose surveillance that runs on promises instead of proof. Before any more money continues, Crossville PD and city leadership should produce a one-page public dashboard: scans, alerts, confirmed hits, cases closed with ALPR as a necessary tool, and cost per outcome. If that page cannot be produced, the city is spending money without knowing what it buys, while logging where residents drive.

THE ASK (say this)

My ask is clear. Cancel Crossville's Flock contract and remove the cameras. Require a public hearing and a recorded City Council vote before any surveillance equipment is ever proposed again. If you will not cancel yet, take a recorded yes-or-no vote each year before any renewal, with no automatic renewal that skips a public vote, and publish monthly use reports the public can check. Thank you. I yield.